(d. AH 389/999 CE), father of Sultan Mahmud of Ghazna (r. AH 389–421/999–1030 CE), and eventually served as a Ghaznavid mint city.[52] Bamiyan remained in Ghaznavid possession until the mid-twelfth-century rise of the Shansabanis.

According to Juzjani, shortly after Ala al-Din Husain *Jahan-suz*'s enraged destruction of Ghazna and Bust-Lashkari Bazar in AH 545/1150 CE, he "turned toward other conquests and captured the regions of Bamiyan and Tukharistan." Here, he installed his eldest brother Fakhr al-Din Mas'ud, whose descendants held the area until their rendition to the Khwarazm-shahs in the first decade of the thirteenth century. But 'Ala' al-Din's initial annexation was evidently not definitive, as he had to return *c.* AH 548/1153–1154 CE to "[bring] under his sway the districts of Bamiyan and Tukharistan," along with the southern areas around Bust (Zamindawar). This would have occurred upon his release after several months in Saljuq captivity, during which time "a group of amirs and dignitaries from the mountains of Ghur … and a group of seditious persons from Kashi" not only put Nasir al-Din from Madin ('Ala' al-Din's nephew) on the throne of Firuzkuh, they also "expropriated the royal treasury and property."[53] It is possible that in suppressing this rebellion, 'Ala' al-Din had to reinstate control over the eastern tracts, attempting to declare the paramountcy specifically of the *Firuzkuh* Shansabanis (cf. Chapter 1). Despite these political vagaries, however, by all appearances Bamiyan and its surrounding valleys continued to comprise a notable mercantile–agricultural complex in the twelfth century. In this respect, it was surely not unlike Jam-Firuzkuh; in fact, given Bamiyan's much longer commercial history and more advantageous location, the latter was at least as prosperous as its western Shansabani counterpart, and probably more so.

As set forth in Chapter 1, cultural patronage – encompassing poetic, literary, and architectural creations – was a fundamental protocol of courtly life throughout the Persianate world, emerging from the politico-economic importance of cultural production. The Bamiyan Shansabanis came to be notable cultural patrons, even rivaling their Firuzkuh cousins.[54] For example, the well-known *littérateur* Nizami 'Aruzi al-Samarqandi (fl. *c.* 1100–1150s CE) was in Saljuq service during the first half of the twelfth century, but later entered 'Ala' al-Din Husain's court, which was presumably at Firuzkuh. However, he ultimately dedicated his *Chahar Maqala* to Husam al-Din 'Ali Abu al-Hasan, a Shansabani prince of Bamiyan (Fakhr al-Din Mas'ud's youngest son), indicating that he was probably lured to the Bamiyan court by the greater benefits offered to him.[55] Fakhr al-Din Mas'ud's grandson, Sultan Baha' al-Din of Bamiyan (r. AH 588–602/1192–1206 CE), was apparently an even more eminent patron of letters and architecture: this sultan patronized Fakhr al-Din ibn 'Umar al-Razi (*c.* AH 544–606/1149–1210 CE), one of the greatest philosophers and theologians after al-Ghazali (d. AH 504/1111 CE), occasioning al-Razi's dedication of *Risala-yi Baha'iyya* (no longer extant) to him.[56] Juzjani additionally